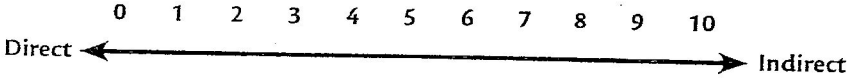


A style that is based on *equality* means people prefer to

- be self-directed,
- have flexibility in the roles they play in a company or on a team,
- have the freedom to challenge the opinion of those in power,
- make exceptions, be flexible, and maybe bend the rules, and
- treat men and women in basically the same way.

A style that is based on *hierarchy* means people prefer to

- take direction from those above,
- have strong limitations about appropriate behavior for certain roles,
- respect and not challenge the opinions of those who are in power because of their status and their position,
- enforce regulations and guidelines, and
- expect men and women to behave differently and to be treated differently.

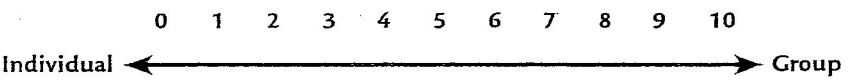


A *direct* style means people prefer to

- be more direct in speaking and be less concerned about how something is said,
- openly confront issues or difficulties,
- communicate concerns straightforwardly,
- engage in conflict when necessary,
- express views or opinions in a frank manner, and
- say things clearly, not leaving much open to interpretation.

An *indirect* style means people prefer to

- focus not just on what is said but on how it is said,
- discreetly avoid difficult or contentious issues,
- express concerns tactfully,
- avoid conflict if at all possible,
- express views or opinions diplomatically, and
- count on the listener to interpret meaning.

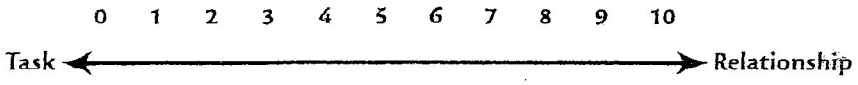


An *individual* style means people prefer to

- take individual initiative,
- use personal guidelines in personal situations,
- focus on themselves,
- judge people based on individual traits,
- make decisions individually,
- put individuals before the team,
- be nonconformists when necessary, and
- move in and out of groups as needed or desired.

A *group* style means people prefer to

- act cooperatively and establish group goals,
- standardize guidelines,
- make loyalty to friends a high priority,
- determine their identity through group affiliation,
- make decisions as a group,
- put the team or group before the individual,
- conform to social norms, and
- keep group membership for life.

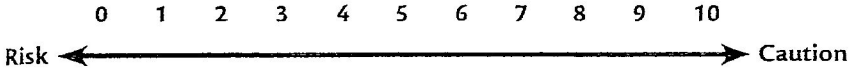


A *task* style means people prefer to

- define people based on what they do,
- move straight to business—relationships come later,
- keep most relationships with co-workers impersonal,
- sacrifice leisure time and time with family in favor of work,
- get to know co-workers and colleagues quickly but usually superficially,
- use largely impersonal selection criteria in hiring (such as résumés or test scores), and
- allow work to overlap with personal time.

A *relationship* style means people prefer to

- define people based on who they are,
- establish comfortable relationships and a sense of mutual trust before getting down to business,
- have personal relationships with co-workers,
- sacrifice work in favor of leisure time and time with family,
- get to know co-workers and colleagues slowly and in depth,
- use largely personal selection criteria (such as family connections) when hiring, and
- not allow work to impinge on personal life.



A *risk* style means people prefer to

- make decisions quickly with little information,
- focus on present and future,
- be less cautious—in a "ready, fire, aim" way,
- change quickly without fear of risks,
- try new and innovative ways of doing things,
- use new methods for solving problems,
- have fewer rules, regulations, guidelines, and directions, and
- be comfortable changing plans at the last minute.

A *caution* style means people prefer to

- collect considerable information before making a decision,
- focus on the past,
- be more cautious—in a "ready, aim, aim, fire" way,
- change slowly and avoid risks,
- want more rules, regulations, guidelines, and directions,
- refer to past precedents of what works and what doesn't,
- stick to proven methods for solving problems, and
- not change plans at the last minute.

